



WMTCP TRAINING MODULE

GALLEY / STEWARD DEPARTMENT

Created by: **Chef Giovani C. Valiente**

Ship's Cook (NC III), TM (TESDA)

NC III Assessor (TESDA) and Culinary Trainer



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TRAINING MODULE OVERVIEW



01

Introduction to the Steward Department

Understanding the role, structure, and importance of the Steward Department within shipboard operations

02

Galley Operations & Organization

Efficient galley management, workflow systems, and operational standards for shipboard kitchens

03

Food Handling & Safety Standards

Proper food handling techniques, contamination prevention, and personal hygiene requirements

04

Galley Management & Best Practices

Cleaning protocols, waste management, and professional standards for galley operations



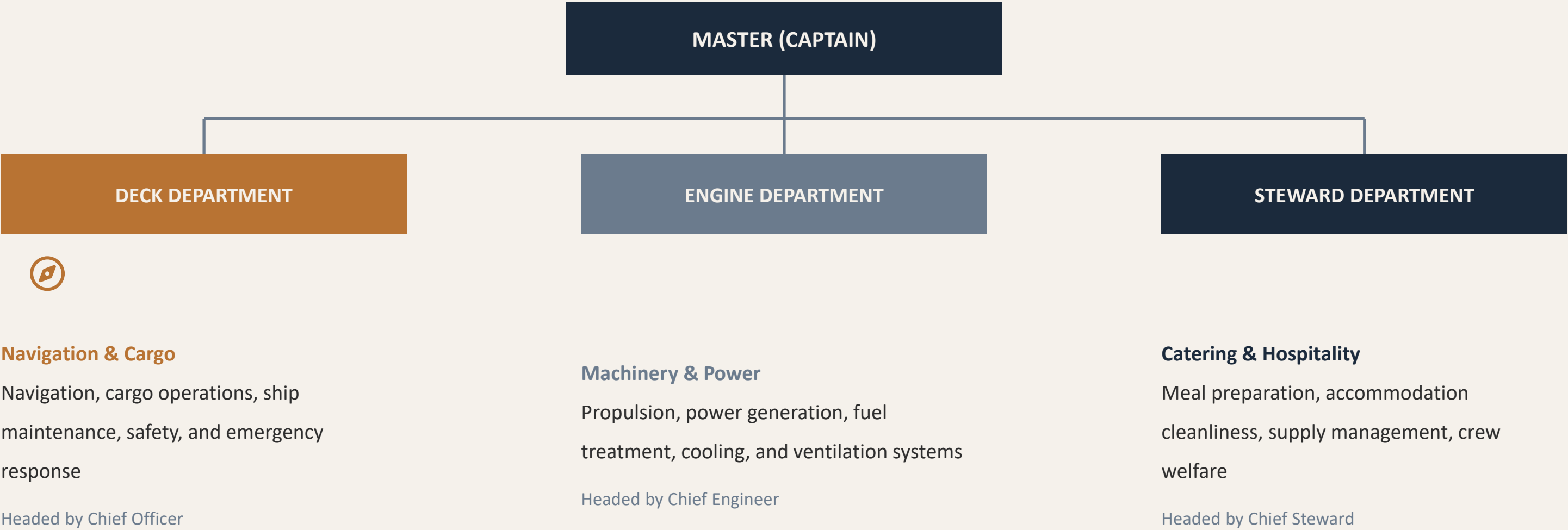
01

INTRODUCTION TO THE STEWARD DEPARTMENT

Understanding the role, structure, and importance of the Steward Department

Department within shipboard operations

Shipboard Organization & the Three Departments



Key Point: The Chief Steward directs and assigns personnel for preparing meals, cleaning and maintaining quarters, managing stores, and overseeing and overseeing inventory and supply ordering. The Steward Department is essential to crew morale and operational readiness.

Roles & Responsibilities in the Steward Department



CHIEF STEWARD / CHIEF COOK

Most senior member with supervisory role

- Oversees daily duties and personnel
- Manages inventory and supply ordering
- Plans menus and ensures meal quality
- Ensures food safety compliance
- Reports to the Master (Captain)



SECOND COOK

Assists chief cook in daily galley operations

- Prepares meals according to menu plans
- Cleans and maintains kitchen equipment
- Stocks supplies and manages stores
- Maintains hygiene and sanitation standards
- Supports food preparation and cooking



ASSISTANT COOK / STEWARD

Entry-level position in the Steward Department

- Helps prepare food and ingredients
- Washes dishes and galley utensils
- Conducts general cleaning duties
- Assists with food storage and inventory
- Supports mess room operations

MESSMAN

Responsible for meal service and mess room

- Serves meals to crew members
- Maintains mess room cleanliness
- Supports galley operations as needed
- Handles dishwashing and sanitation
- Assists with food transport and storage



02

GALLEY OPERATIONS & ORGANIZATION

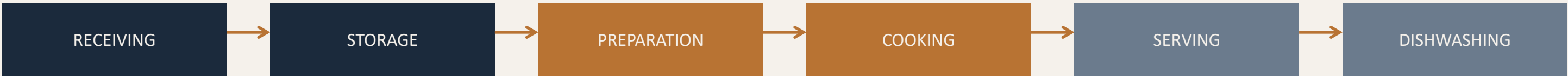
Efficient galley management, workflow systems, and operational standards for standards for shipboard kitchens



Galley Layout & Work Areas



ONE-WAY WORKFLOW PATTERN



FUNCTIONAL ZONES

COOKING AREA

Stoves, ovens, fryers, grills, and exhaust systems. All equipment must be secured with sway gear for rough weather.

PREPARATION AREA

Cutting, portioning, marinating, and assembling. Color-coded cutting boards required for different food types.

DISHWASHING AREA

Sink, dishwasher, drying racks, and waste disposal. Three-compartment sink setup for wash, rinse, sanitize.

STORAGE AREAS

Dry stores, refrigeration (+5°C), and freezer (-18°C). FIFO system must be strictly followed for all provisions.

ROUGH WEATHER PREP

Use sway gear on stoves | Secure refrigerator and freezer doors | Install fiddles on all shelves | Keep shelves 15cm above deck level | Place damp towels on tables for stability

Food Safety & Hygiene Fundamentals



Marine galley operations present unique food safety challenges due to limited storage, extended supply chains, and the critical importance of crew health. **Three types of contamination** must be prevented at all times.

TYPES OF CONTAMINATION

PHYSICAL

Foreign objects that accidentally enter food:

- Stone fragments in bread
- Hair from food handlers
- Eggshell pieces
- Metal fragments from equipment

CHEMICAL

Improper storage or environmental exposure:

- Cleaning product residue
- Non-food-grade containers
- Diesel fumes near food
- Copper/galvanized metals

BIOLOGICAL

Most serious daily risk in galley operations:

- Bacteria (Salmonella, E. coli)
- Viruses and parasites
- Cross-contamination
- Infected food handlers

FOOD HANDLER HEALTH REQUIREMENTS

All food handlers must be symptom-free for at least **48 hours** before resuming duties after gastrointestinal illness. Proper medical documentation is required.

 **Critical:** Food safety failures aboard vessels can compromise crew health and vessel operations. Always follow established hygiene protocols and temperature guidelines.

Temperature Control — The Danger Zone



DANGER ZONE: 5°C — 65°C (Bacteria multiply rapidly in this range)

Below 0°C — Bacterial growth stops (Freezing)

0°C — 5°C — Growth slows (Refrigeration)

5°C — 65°C DANGER ZONE
Rapid bacterial multiplication

Above 65°C — Hot holding zone

75°C+ — Kills pathogenic bacteria

100°C destroys most bacteria but spores may survive. 120°C eliminates bacterial spores.

CRITICAL STORAGE TEMPERATURES

Food Category	Max Temp	Notes
Minced meat, raw sausages	+ 2°C	Also during defrosting
Fresh fish, seafood	+ 2°C	Store on ice if possible
Raw meat, poultry	+ 5°C	Whole pieces only
Milk, dairy products	+ 5°C	Fresh pasteurized items

HOT HOLDING REQUIREMENTS

Hot foods must be maintained at 65°C minimum

Buffet items: maximum **3-hour** exposure time

Reheat leftovers to **75°C minimum** core temperature



03

FOOD HANDLING & SAFETY STANDARDS

Proper food handling techniques, contamination prevention, and personal hygiene requirements



Cross-Contamination Prevention



COLOR-CODED CUTTING BOARD SYSTEM

RED Raw Meat	YELLOW Poultry	BLUE Fish & Seafood	GREEN Vegetables & Fruits	BROWN Bread & Baked Goods	WHITE Cold Cuts & Prepared
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PREVENTION PROTOCOLS

DO — Required Practices

- Clean surfaces between different ingredients
- Wash hands before, during, and after cooking
- Use separate utensils for raw and cooked foods
- Store raw ingredients below ready-to-eat foods
- Use designated cutting boards for each food type
- Label all containers with contents and dates

DON'T — Prohibited Practices

- Never use same board for raw and cooked foods
- Never store raw meat above ready-to-eat items
- Never reuse marinades on cooked foods
- Never handle food with unwashed hands
- Never ignore the color-coding system
- Never skip cleaning between food types



Remember: Cross-contamination is one of the leading causes of foodborne illness at sea. The color-coded system exists to protect crew health — use it consistently.



Personal Hygiene Standards for Food Handlers

WHEN TO WASH HANDS

1

Before handling any food items

2

Between handling different ingredients

3

After touching contaminated surfaces

4

After using the restroom

PERSONAL CONDUCT STANDARDS

Required Practices

- Wear clean uniforms at all times
- Keep fingernails short and clean
- Cover cuts with waterproof bandages
- Use food-grade gloves over wounds
- Tie back or cover long hair
- Wear minimal jewelry (wedding band only)

Prohibited Behaviors

- Smoking near food preparation areas
- Spitting or coughing near food
- Eating while preparing food
- Working while sick (48-hr rule applies)
- Wearing strong perfumes or colognes
- Using mobile phones in food areas

 **Health Rule:** Crew with gastrointestinal illness must be symptom-free for **48 hours** with medical documentation before resuming food duties.

Safe Food Storage & Inventory Management



FIFO PRINCIPLE — FIRST IN, FIRST OUT

Always use the oldest stock first. When new provisions arrive, place them **behind** existing stock. All containers must be clearly **labeled with contents and dates**. Check expiration dates during every inventory audit.

STORAGE REQUIREMENTS

Requirement	Standard
Containers	Food-grade only, proper markings
Cooling large portions	Cool on trays before containerizing
Cooling time	65°C to 10°C within 3 hours max
Freezer storage	-18°C for long-term storage
Leftover use-by	Use prepared leftovers within 1 month

INVENTORY BEST PRACTICES

- Conduct **daily stock audits** during extended voyages
- Dynamically adjust menus based on available stock
- Monitor for critical shortages early
- Prevent overuse of key provisions
- Plan meals around perishable items first
- Document all inventory changes
- Report discrepancies to Chief Steward immediately



SUPPLY SHORTAGE PROTOCOLS

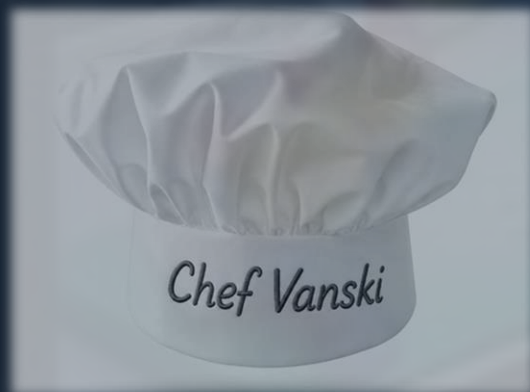
During supply disruptions: adapt menus to use non-perishables, implement portion control, repurpose leftovers creatively, and communicate rationing guidelines clearly to all crew.



04

GALLEY MANAGEMENT & BEST PRACTICES

Cleaning protocols, waste management, and professional standards for galley
galley operations





Cleaning, Sanitation & Equipment Maintenance

CLEANING SCHEDULE REQUIREMENTS

- Implement a **comprehensive cleaning schedule** with visual signage
- All food-contact surfaces must be **disinfected before use**
- Equipment must be smooth, corrosion-resistant, easy to sanitize
- No grease, soil, or signs of infestation in food prep areas
- Clean spills immediately to prevent slipping hazards
- Use magnetic knife racks for safe storage
- Keep shelves **15cm above deck level**

FACILITY REQUIREMENTS

- Handwashing stations with clear instructions
- Food-safe sinks with potable water supply
- Proper drainage with air breaks
- Hygienic storage for ice and water
- Well-lit and ventilated galley areas
- Lidded waste containers, kept closed
- Durable, non-absorbent dining surfaces

FIRE PREVENTION & SAFETY



- Never use saucepans as deep fryers
- Cover grease fires to starve oxygen
- **Never use water on grease fires**
- Maintain clean exhaust systems
- Know the location of fire extinguishers

EQUIPMENT MAINTENANCE



- Report malfunctioning equipment immediately
- Regular equipment maintenance schedule
- Replace worn or damaged items promptly
- Calibrate temperature probes every 6-12 months
- Do not use glass containers in galley

Leftover Management & Waste Control



SAFE LEFTOVER REUSE GUIDELINES

 **REHEAT**
Reheat leftovers to **75°C** minimum core temperature

 **ONE-TIME USE**
Use leftovers **only once** after reheating — no second reheat

 **TIME LIMIT**
Discard buffet items after **3 hours** maximum exposure

 **NO MIXING**
Never mix old and new food together

BUFFET MANAGEMENT

Parameter	Minimum	Maximum
Hot food holding	65°C	—
Cold food holding	—	5°C
Buffet exposure time	—	3 hours

WASTE MANAGEMENT

- Waste separation per company environmental policy
- Food waste disposed per **MARPOL** regulations
- Lidded containers, kept closed at all times
- Regular waste removal from galley areas
- Clean bins after each emptying

SMART MENU PLANNING FOR LEFTOVERS

Tip: Plan dishes that generate useful leftovers. Design follow-up meals using leftover ingredients. Example: Salmon steaks on Monday can become salmon flan on Tuesday. This ensures waste reduction while maintaining food safety standards.



TRAINING SUMMARY & KEY TAKEAWAYS

KEY PRINCIPLES TO REMEMBER

-  Follow proper **food safety and hygiene protocols** at all times — crew health depends on it
-  Maintain **strict temperature control** — keep foods out of the 5°C–65°C danger zone
-  Use **color-coded systems** to prevent cross-contamination between food types
-  Apply **FIFO inventory management** and proper leftover handling procedures
-  Keep all galley areas **clean, organized**, and equipment well-maintained

Remember: Food safety failures can compromise crew health and vessel operations.



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